MODULE 37 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

Confusion pairs

Every look-alike in this course, side by side, with the sentence that separates them.

MODULE 37 of 43 DOMAIN Exam skills WEIGHT revision

admin@sthithapragna.com

A well-written question makes **two options defensible** and one detail decisive.

Working with confusion pairs

- For each pair, learn **the discriminating sentence**, not two feature lists.
- In the exam, find the discriminator **in the scenario** before reading the options.
- If you cannot find it, the question may be testing a different pair than you assumed.
- Two options that both look right usually means you have not spotted the planted detail yet.
- Eight scenarios at the end are all discriminations. No new facts appear in any of them.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Reading the options first is what makes two of them look equally good. Read the scenario for the deciding fact, then read the options.

Data preparation look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Glue or EMR	Glue for serverless ETL. EMR when you need Spark control or already run it
Glue or Lambda	Lambda for small and event-driven. Glue when the data does not fit 15 minutes
Parquet or Avro	Parquet for columnar analytics reads. Avro for row-wise writes and schema evolution
Online or offline store	Online for low-latency serving. Offline for training and point-in-time queries
Ground Truth or A2I	Ground Truth labels a dataset. A2I reviews live predictions

ON THE EXAM

Row five is the one people invert: labelling happens before training, human review happens after deployment.

Ingestion look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Kinesis Data Streams or Firehose	Streams for custom processing. Firehose to deliver
Firehose or MSK	MSK when you already run Kafka
Streaming or batch ingestion	Does the decision need data from seconds ago?
S3 or EFS for training data	EFS for shared low-latency reads. S3 otherwise
File, Pipe or FastFile mode	Pipe streams. FastFile reads on demand

ON THE EXAM

Row five is a training-time performance choice, not a storage choice, and it is easy to confuse with the row above it.

Query and storage look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Athena or Redshift	Ad hoc over S3, or a warehouse you maintain
Parquet or ORC	Both columnar. Parquet is the broader default
CSV or Parquet	CSV for interchange. Parquet for anything at scale
S3 storage classes	Access frequency decides. Lifecycle rules automate it
Data Wrangler or Glue	Interactive preparation, or a production ETL job

ON THE EXAM

Row three is the cheapest win in Domain 1: converting to Parquet reduces both scan cost and training read time.

Bias and retrieval look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Pre- or post-training bias	Post-training needs model predictions
Semantic or hybrid search	Hybrid for exact codes. Needs OpenSearch Serverless
Fixed or semantic chunking	Semantic when passages vary in structure
Chunk size or top-k	What a passage holds, or how many you get
Oversampling or class weights	Weights avoid duplicating rows

ON THE EXAM

Row one has a cost consequence: post-training bias needs an endpoint, so it is slower and dearer.

Fine-tuning or retrieval?

FINE-TUNING CHANGES

How the model behaves

- Format, tone, structure, style.
- A task the base model does badly.
- Knowledge is baked in and goes stale.
- Retraining is the only update.

RETRIEVAL CHANGES

What the model knows

- Facts from your own documents.
- Content that changes over time.
- Citations, and an audit trail.
- Updating means re-indexing.

THE TIEBREAKER

Behaviour or knowledge. If the complaint is 'it does not know our policies', that is retrieval. If it is 'it will not use our format', that is fine-tuning.

admin@sthithapragna.com

Modelling look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Bagging or boosting	Bagging reduces variance in parallel. Boosting reduces bias sequentially
Bayesian or Random tuning	Bayesian learns and is sequential. Random parallelises fully
Hyperband or Bayesian	Hyperband needs per-epoch metrics, and stops bad trials early
L1 or L2 regularisation	L1 drives coefficients to zero, so it selects features
Underfitting or overfitting	Both scores poor is underfitting. Train good, validation poor is overfitting

ON THE EXAM

Row three is the cost answer: if a scenario complains tuning is expensive, Hyperband and early stopping are what it wants.

admin@sthithapragna.com

Built-in algorithm look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
XGBoost or Linear Learner	Non-linear tabular, or a fast linear baseline
Random Cut Forest or IP Insights	General anomalies, or entity-and-IP pairs
k-NN or Factorization Machines	Similarity lookup, or sparse interactions
BlazingText or Object2Vec	Word embeddings, or embeddings of arbitrary objects
DeepAR or a regression model	Many related series with seasonality means DeepAR

ON THE EXAM

Random Cut Forest against IP Insights is the classic pair: one is generic, the other is specifically about who connected from where.

Build-versus-buy look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Canvas or Autopilot	No-code interface, or the API and SDK
Autopilot or a custom model	Autopilot first. It is a strong baseline for tabular
JumpStart or Bedrock	An endpoint you control, or a managed API
Managed AI service or custom	Comprehend, Textract, Transcribe before training anything
Pretrained or from scratch	From scratch needs a reason the exam will state

ON THE EXAM

The exam consistently rewards the highest level of abstraction that meets the stated requirement. Building from scratch is almost never it.

Evaluation look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Precision or recall	What costs more: a false alarm, or a miss?
ROC-AUC or PR-AUC	Severe class imbalance flatters ROC-AUC. Use PR-AUC
MAE or RMSE	RMSE when large errors are disproportionately damaging
BLEU or ROUGE	BLEU is precision and translation. ROUGE is recall and summarisation
Validation or test	Validation is used for decisions. Test is touched once
Macro or micro average	Macro exposes rare-class performance. Micro hides it

ON THE EXAM

Every row here reduces to one question: what does being wrong cost, and to whom?

Training performance look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Batch size or learning rate	Raising batch size means retuning the learning rate
Epochs or early stopping	Early stopping finds the epoch count for you
Data parallel or model parallel	Model does not fit means model parallel
More instances or a bigger one	Communication overhead can outweigh more instances
Pipe mode or a bigger volume	Streaming avoids waiting for a full download

ON THE EXAM

Row one is a cause of silent underperformance: scaling batch size without retuning the learning rate degrades the result quietly.

Generative evaluation look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Classical metric or LLM-as-a-judge	No reference answer means a judge
BERTScore or a judge	BERTScore fixes paraphrase, not truth. It still needs a reference
Retrieve-only or retrieve-and-generate	Only means diagnose the retriever. Both means judge the answer
Context relevance or coverage	Relevance is noise. Coverage is a gap
Correctness or faithfulness	Faithfulness asks whether the sources support it, not whether it is true
Temperature or top-p	Both control randomness. Change one, not both

ON THE EXAM

Row five is the one worth over-learning: an answer can be correct and unfaithful, and in a grounded system that is still a failure.

SHAP or partial dependence?

SHAP

Local or global

- Why was this one prediction made?
- Signed, so it gives direction.
- Averaged, it also gives global importance.
- Needed for a per-decision explanation.

PARTIAL DEPENDENCE

Always global

- What does this feature do generally?
- Shows non-linearity across a range.
- Never explains one prediction.
- Misleads on correlated features.

THE TIEBREAKER

One prediction or the whole model. A regulator asking why this applicant was declined needs SHAP, and a PDP cannot answer it.

Inference option look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Real-time or serverless	Sustained traffic, GPU, or over 4 MB means real-time
Serverless or async	Serverless is under 4 MB and 60 s. Async is up to 1 GB and one hour
Async or batch	Async: requests arrive over time. Batch: the dataset already exists
Batch or real-time	Is anybody waiting for an individual result?
Scale-to-zero or serverless	Waking from zero fails requests. A cold start delays them

ON THE EXAM

Row five is the sharpest distinction in Domain 3, and the most consequential: a failed request is not a slow request.

Compute look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
CPU or GPU	Can the model keep a GPU busy at your batch size?
Graviton or x86	Graviton needs an Arm64 container image
Inferentia or GPU	Inferentia repays through sustained volume
Inferentia or Trainium	Inference-first, or training-first silicon
G family or P family	Inference-oriented, or training-class accelerator memory

ON THE EXAM

Every row here is answered by measurement rather than instinct, which is why Inference Recommender exists.

Endpoint architecture look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Multi-model or multi-container	Same framework, or different frameworks
Multi-container or pipeline	Direct is independent. Serial is a pipeline
Multi-model or separate endpoints	Consistent low latency means separate
Pipeline or Feature Store	Per-request transforms, or shared features
Multi-model or components	Components allocate resources explicitly

ON THE EXAM

Multi-container and inference pipeline are the same feature with different execution modes.

Deployment look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Canary or linear	Linear minimises risk. Canary balances risk and duration
Shadow or canary	Shadow: no user sees the output. Canary: some users do
Canary or A/B	Canary asks is it safe. A/B asks is it better
Blue/green or traffic shifting	Blue/green is automatic. You choose the shifting mode
Compilation or quantization	Compilation is accuracy-neutral. Quantization is not
Quantization or speculative decoding	Quantization cuts memory. Speculative decoding adds a second model

ON THE EXAM

Row two is the one to read carefully: 'no customer may receive the new model's output' eliminates every traffic-shifting option at once.

Foundation model look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
On-demand or Provisioned Throughput	Predictable sustained volume, and a willingness to commit
Retrieve or RetrieveAndGenerate	Retrieve returns chunks. RetrieveAndGenerate returns an answer
Custom Model Import or an endpoint	Import for Bedrock tooling. Endpoint for instance control
Bedrock or SageMaker AI for an FM	Inferentia or the optimisation toolkit means an endpoint
Agent or workflow	If you can draw the flowchart, build the flowchart
Tool use or agent	One call is tool use. A loop is an agent

ON THE EXAM

Rows five and six are the pattern ladder: prompt, retrieve, tool, workflow, agent. The exam rewards the lowest rung that works.

Bedrock API look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Converse or InvokeModel	Converse is unified. InvokeModel for imported models
Converse or ConverseStream	Streaming changes perceived latency, not total time
inferenceConfig or additionalModelRequestFields	Four standard params, or model-specific ones
Temperature or maxTokens	Randomness, or how long the answer may be
Prompt caching or routing	Reuse a prefix, or send easy requests elsewhere

ON THE EXAM

Row one carries a real constraint: the Converse API does not support imported models, so portable code needs the Invoke API there.

Orchestration look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Pipelines or Step Functions	Pipelines when every step is a SageMaker AI job
Pipelines or MWAA	MWAA when the team already runs Airflow
Caching or selective execution	Automatic, or deliberate
Data dependency or add_depends_on	Passing data, or ordering only
Schedule or event trigger	A schedule fires when nothing changed

ON THE EXAM

Row five is worth arguing for at work: trigger on data or drift, not the calendar.

Agent platform look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Agents Classic or AgentCore	Classic is in maintenance. AgentCore for new work
Action groups or Gateway	The same idea. Gateway needs explicit tool definition
Session memory or AgentCore Memory	Short-term, or short and long term with strategies
Supervisor or routing mode	Supervisor via MCP works. Routing mode is limited
AgentCore Runtime or runtime instances	Eight hours, or up to fourteen days with GPU

ON THE EXAM

Row four is AWS's own documented gap, and it is unusually candid: full multi-agent collaboration still needs custom framework code.

Data drift or concept drift?

DATA DRIFT

The inputs changed

- The feature distribution moved.
- Detectable without any labels.
- The relationship may still hold.
- Caught by comparing to a baseline.

CONCEPT DRIFT

The relationship changed

- The same inputs now mean something else.
- Needs ground truth to detect.
- Inputs can look completely normal.
- Caught by model quality falling.

THE TIEBREAKER

Inputs look normal and accuracy fell is concept drift. Inputs moved and accuracy held is data drift that has not mattered yet.

Observability look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Metrics or logs	Is it healthy, or what did it print?
Logs or CloudTrail	Application behaviour, or who called an API?
X-Ray or prompt tracing	Across services, or across components
ModelLatency or OverheadLatency	Inside the container, or around it
No logs or no metrics	Failed before printing, or no traffic

ON THE EXAM

Row five: both look like nothing is there, and they mean opposite things.

Monitoring type look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Data quality or model quality	Inputs against a baseline, or predictions against labels
Model bias or feature attribution drift	Fairness over time, or what the model relies on
Baseline or schedule	What normal looks like, or how often you check
Data capture or invocation logging	Endpoint payloads, or Bedrock prompts and responses
Proxy signal or scheduled evaluation	Moves early, or actually measures quality

ON THE EXAM

Row five is the whole shape of Domain 4 for generative systems: proxies warn, and only a scheduled evaluation measures.

Security look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
VPC mode or network isolation	Where the job sits, or whether it can talk at all
Short-term or long-term API key	Long-term creates a persistent IAM user
API key or IAM role	If the caller can assume a role, it should
IAM policy or KMS key policy	Both must permit it. List works, read fails means KMS
Identity policy or resource policy	What a principal may do, or who may use a resource
SCP or permission boundary	Both are ceilings. Neither grants anything

ON THE EXAM

Row four has a signature worth memorising, because it identifies the cause from the symptom alone.

Safety and cost look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Grounding or Automated Reasoning	Probabilistic against a source, or formal logic against a policy
Content filter or denied topic	Harmful content, or a subject you simply do not cover
Word filter or denied topic	Exact strings, or an intent that survives rephrasing
Block or mask PII	Block what must never appear. Mask what should be scrubbed
Savings Plan or Spot	A financial commitment, or an interruptible job
Spot or on-demand	Does anything downstream depend on when it finishes?

ON THE EXAM

Row one is the newest pair in the course and the most likely to appear: both address hallucination by entirely different mechanisms.

Cost tooling look-alikes

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Cost Explorer or Budgets	Analyse the past, or alert on the present
Budgets or Anomaly Detection	A threshold you set, or a pattern it learns
Trusted Advisor or Compute Optimizer	Idle resources, or right-sizing from utilisation
Tags or accounts	Attribution within an account, or a hard boundary
Right-size or commit	Fix utilisation first. A discount on waste is still waste

ON THE EXAM

Row five is the ordering rule for the whole of Domain 4's cost material, and the one teams most often get backwards.

Pairs that span the course

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Feature Store or inference pipeline	Both fix skew. Shared features, or per-request transforms
Prompt, retrieve, fine-tune, train	How little can you build? Module 12's ladder
Evaluation or monitoring	Before deployment, or continuously after it
Guardrail or instruction	One enforces. The other asks
Alarm or gate	An alarm tells you. A gate stops it
Measure or commit	Measure utilisation first. A discount on waste is still waste

ON THE EXAM

These six are less about services and more about judgement, which is exactly what the harder questions are testing.

Where a control belongs

PAIR	THE DISCRIMINATOR
Prompt or policy	An instruction asks. A policy enforces
Application check or IAM	Code can be bypassed. IAM cannot
Documentation or infrastructure as code	One describes. The other reproduces
Review or gate	A review can be skipped under deadline pressure
Training the team or automating it	Automation survives the person leaving

ON THE EXAM

Five phrasings of one idea: prefer the control the system enforces over the one a person is supposed to remember.

Ten discriminators worth memorising

PAIR	ONE SENTENCE
Fine-tune or retrieve	Behaviour or knowledge
Async or batch	Requests arriving, or a dataset sitting
Multi-model or multi-container	Same framework, or different frameworks
Shadow or canary	Nobody sees it, or some people do
Data or concept drift	Inputs moved, or the relationship changed
VPC mode or isolation	Where it sits, or whether it can talk
Grounding or Automated Reasoning	Probabilistic, or formal logic
Precision or recall	False alarms, or misses
Compilation or quantization	Accuracy-neutral, or not
Savings Plan or Spot	Commitment, or interruptibility

ON THE EXAM

If you memorise one slide in this module, memorise this one. Ten sentences, and they cover most of what the exam confuses deliberately.

Find the planted detail before you read the options. It is always there.

> An insurance company processes claim documents submitted by adjusters throughout the day. Each document is 40 to 80 MB and takes around eight minutes to analyse. Adjusters submit them individually and want results back within the hour.
>
> Volume is roughly 200 documents a day, unevenly spread.

Which inference option fits?

A. Asynchronous inference, with results to S3 and an SNS notification

B. Batch transform, run every thirty minutes over submitted documents

C. Real-time inference on a large instance

D. Serverless inference with maximum memory

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which inference option fits?

A Asynchronous inference, with results to S3 and an SNS notification

Requests arrive individually through the day, payloads are well inside 1 GB, and eight minutes is inside the one-hour limit.

B Batch transform, run every thirty minutes over submitted documents

Would work, and the dataset does not exist up front. Documents arrive one at a time, which is the async shape, not the batch shape.

C Real-time inference on a large instance

80 MB exceeds the 25 MB payload limit, and eight minutes exceeds the 60-second timeout. It fails on both numbers.

D Serverless inference with maximum memory

4 MB payload and 60 seconds. It fails more comprehensively than real-time does.

THE SIGNAL

Async or batch: requests arriving individually, or a dataset already sitting there. Here they arrive one at a time.

A team hosts three models that are invoked independently by different services: a PyTorch image model, a scikit-learn scorer and an XGBoost ranker. None receives enough traffic to justify its own instance.

They want per-model CloudWatch metrics and to restrict which service can call which model.

What should they deploy?

A. A multi-model endpoint with all three artefacts under one prefix

B. An inference pipeline chaining the three containers

C. A multi-container endpoint in direct mode

D. Three serverless endpoints, one per model

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should they deploy?

A. A multi-model endpoint with all three artefacts under one prefix

Multi-model shares ONE container, so every model must use the same framework. Three frameworks cannot share one runtime.

B. An inference pipeline chaining the three containers

Serial execution sends every request through all three. These are invoked independently by different services.

C. A multi-container endpoint in direct mode

Three frameworks, invoked independently, under the limit of five. Direct mode gives per-container metrics and IAM restriction by container name.

D. Three serverless endpoints, one per model

Reasonable, and it gives up the consolidation the scenario is asking for, with three things to operate instead of one.

THE SIGNAL

Three different frameworks rules out multi-model immediately. Invoked independently rules out serial. That leaves one option.

> A demand forecasting model's accuracy has fallen steadily over four months. Model Monitor reports no data quality violations, and the input feature distributions are within their baseline ranges.
>
> The business changed its delivery promise from five days to next day during that period.

What is happening?

A Data drift. Retrain on recent data to restore the baseline

B Concept drift. The relationship between features and demand has changed

C A pipeline fault. The features are being computed incorrectly

D Model degradation from an expired container image

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is happening?

A Data drift. Retrain on recent data to restore the baseline

Data drift means the input distributions moved. The scenario states explicitly that they have not.

B Concept drift. The relationship between features and demand has changed

Inputs look normal and accuracy fell. A changed delivery promise changes what the same inputs imply about demand.

C A pipeline fault. The features are being computed incorrectly

A fault would show as a data quality violation or a distribution shift. Monitor reports neither.

D Model degradation from an expired container image

A model artefact does not degrade with age. The image serves the same weights indefinitely.

THE SIGNAL

Inputs normal, accuracy falling, and a stated change in the world. That combination is concept drift every time.

A benefits assistant must never tell a claimant they are eligible for a payment they do not qualify for. Eligibility is defined by a documented set of rules about age, contribution history and residency.

The team wants responses verified against those rules, with an explanation when a response is rejected.

Which safeguard fits?

A Contextual grounding checks, with the rules document as the grounding source

B Denied topics covering eligibility statements

C Content filters at HIGH strength on the output

D Automated Reasoning checks, with the rules authored as a policy

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which safeguard fits?

A Contextual grounding checks, with the rules document as the grounding source

Probabilistic scoring of support. It can score a wrong eligibility claim as well supported if the wording resembles the source.

B Denied topics covering eligibility statements

Blocks the assistant from discussing eligibility, which is the one thing it exists to do.

C Content filters at HIGH strength on the output

Content filters address harmful content. A wrong eligibility decision is incorrect, not harmful by category.

D Automated Reasoning checks, with the rules authored as a policy

Formal logic against authored rules, and it can explain why a claim is wrong. Eligibility criteria are exactly the logically verifiable case.

THE SIGNAL

Two signals point here: rules that are genuinely formal, and a requirement for an explanation rather than a score.

> A hospital trains a model using a vendor-supplied container on patient records. The information governance board requires assurance that the vendor's code cannot transmit any patient data outside the account.
>
> The container image includes all its dependencies. Input and output are S3 paths in the hospital's own account.

What should they configure?

A. VpcConfig, placing the job in a private subnet with S3 endpoints

B. EnableNetworkIsolation on the training job

C. EnableInterContainerTrafficEncryption on the training job

D. A customer-managed KMS key on the training volume

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should they configure?

A. VpcConfig, placing the job in a private subnet with S3 endpoints

A sensible layer, and the container can still make calls to whatever those endpoints permit. It restricts the destination rather than forbidding calls.

B. EnableNetworkIsolation on the training job

The container cannot make any outbound call, while SageMaker AI still stages input and output. That is the assurance the board asked for.

C. EnableInterContainerTrafficEncryption on the training job

Encrypts traffic between instances in a distributed job. It does not stop a container calling out.

D. A customer-managed KMS key on the training volume

Protects data at rest on the volume. It says nothing about what the container transmits.

THE SIGNAL

VPC mode or network isolation: where it sits, or whether it can talk. 'Cannot transmit anywhere' is unambiguously the second.

> A team is comparing two fraud models. Positives are 0.3 percent of transactions. Both models show ROC-AUC above 0.97, and the team cannot separate them.
>
> In production, one of them flags far more legitimate transactions than the other at the same catch rate.

What should they compare on?

A PR-AUC, plus precision and recall at the deployed threshold

B Accuracy, which will separate them at this class balance

C F1 on the training set, to avoid test-set contamination

D Log loss, which is sensitive to probability calibration

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should they compare on?

A PR-AUC, plus precision and recall at the deployed threshold

PR-AUC ignores true negatives, so 99.7 percent negatives cannot flatter it. Precision at threshold expresses the false-alarm difference directly.

B Accuracy, which will separate them at this class balance

At 0.3 percent positives, both models score above 99 percent whatever they do. Accuracy separates nothing here.

C F1 on the training set, to avoid test-set contamination

A training metric measures memorisation. Comparing models on it tells you nothing about production behaviour.

D Log loss, which is sensitive to probability calibration

A real metric, and it measures calibration rather than the false-alarm difference the scenario describes.

THE SIGNAL

ROC-AUC or PR-AUC: severe imbalance flatters the first. A huge pile of true negatives is exactly what PR-AUC refuses to count.

> A research group runs GPU training jobs most weekdays, but volume varies widely: some weeks are heavy, others nearly idle. Their training scripts checkpoint every epoch. No individual job has a deadline.
>
> Finance wants the training bill reduced and will not approve any multi-year commitment.

What should they do?

A. Buy a one-year Savings Plan sized to their average weekly usage

B. Move training to serverless inference to remove idle cost

C. Reserve GPU capacity to guarantee availability

D. Enable Managed Spot Training, with max_wait above max_run

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should they do?

A. Buy a one-year Savings Plan sized to their average weekly usage

Commitments suit steady usage. Volume varies widely, so an average-sized commitment is wasted in quiet weeks and overflows in busy ones.

B. Move training to serverless inference to remove idle cost

Serverless inference serves predictions. It does not train models.

C. Reserve GPU capacity to guarantee availability

Solves availability and raises cost. The requirement is to reduce the bill without committing.

D. Enable Managed Spot Training, with max_wait above max_run

Checkpointing exists, no job has a deadline, and volume is bursty. Every condition for Spot is stated, for up to 90 percent off.

THE SIGNAL

Savings Plan or Spot: a commitment suits steady spend, and Spot suits interruptible work. Bursty plus checkpointed plus no deadline is Spot.

A law firm's assistant answers questions about the firm's internal procedures. Complaints are that it does not know about procedures introduced in the last eighteen months, and occasionally states superseded ones as current.

Its tone and output format are consistently correct and nobody has complained about them.

What should they do?

A Fine-tune the model on the full procedure library

B Raise the temperature so the model is less rigid

C Build a knowledge base over the procedure library, with a regular sync

D Switch to a larger model with a more recent training cutoff

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should they do?

A Fine-tune the model on the full procedure library

Fine-tuning bakes knowledge in, so it goes stale again and the next procedure change needs another training run.

B Raise the temperature so the model is less rigid

Temperature controls randomness, not knowledge. A more varied wrong answer is still wrong.

C Build a knowledge base over the procedure library, with a regular sync

The complaint is knowledge, and it changes over time. Retrieval keeps current, cites sources, and re-syncing replaces superseded procedures.

D Switch to a larger model with a more recent training cutoff

No public model was trained on this firm's internal procedures at any cutoff.

THE SIGNAL

Fine-tune or retrieve: behaviour or knowledge. Tone and format are already correct, and the missing thing changes every few months.

What to take from this module

- **Find the planted detail first.** A file size, a deadline, a framework, a tolerance.
- **Two defensible options means one is being separated by a single fact.** Go and find it.
- **Learn the discriminating sentence**, not two feature lists you already know.
- **Reading the options first** is what makes two of them look equally good.
- The ten-row master table is the single most revisable slide in this module.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Module 38 maps what is in maintenance mode, what replaced it, and what to answer anyway.